What Michigan's new majority said about health care

Election-night speeches and first press appearances from the Democratic leaders who won the governorship, the Legislature, and Michigan's open U.S. Senate seat, transcribed, analyzed, and linked to the moment each line was spoken.

9 speeches and press events analyzed	**6** leaders on camera	**79** minutes of video transcribed
28 statements on health care	**3** leaders who addressed health care	**12** statements with direct hospital stakes

INSIDE

Executive summary · Signals for hospitals · Themes & quotes · Leader profiles · Source videos

Michigan Health & Hospital Association

Prepared November 4, 2026

01

Executive summary

Health care was a central theme in election-night messaging but concentrated among few voices. Of **6** leaders on camera across **9** speeches and press events, only **3** addressed health care directly, producing **28** statements across **79** minutes of transcribed video. Senator-elect Abdul El-Sayed generated the vast majority, framing health care as unaffordable, corporate-dominated, and in need of structural overhaul. Rep. Debbie Dingell contributed statements emphasizing Medicaid anxiety among constituents and cost-of-living pressures. Governor-elect Jocelyn Benson offered brief pledges on affordable health care costs and women's health access. Separately, likely incoming Speaker Ranjeev Puri told the election-night watch party, per the Michigan Advance, that he 'watched healthcare be ripped away from our sick,' but he named no specific health policy that night.

The most actionable policy signals for hospitals center on Medicaid and federal spending. Both El-Sayed and Dingell identified reversing scheduled federal Medicaid cuts as an immediate priority; Dingell placed reversal among 'one of the first things' the new House majority would pursue, while El-Sayed warned that coverage losses would shift costs onto hospitals through increased emergency department use. El-Sayed predicted Republican crossover support for reversal, especially in rural communities. On coverage, Dingell committed to reinstating the ACA premium tax credit as an interim step, and El-Sayed warned of a premium cost spiral if coverage gaps widen. El-Sayed's repeated endorsement of Medicare for All and his criticism of Blue Cross Blue Shield's market dominance signal sustained scrutiny of insurer pricing and market structure. Notably absent from all appearances were hospital workforce shortages, detailed behavioral health policy, and any discussion of hospital finances or reimbursement.

MOST-DISCUSSED TOPICS

1 **Health care costs & affordability** 15

2 **Insurers, corporate & private-equity influence** 7

3 **ACA subsidies & coverage** 6

4 **Medicaid & Healthy Michigan Plan** 5

5 **Federal health cuts (H.R. 1)** 4

Statements can carry more than one topic.

02

Signals for hospitals

What these first appearances suggest MHA should watch for or prepare for, each tied to the statements behind it.

01 Medicaid cuts reversal as early federal priority

Both Dingell and El-Sayed identified reversing scheduled federal Medicaid reductions as among the new majority's first acts, with El-Sayed warning that coverage losses would increase uncompensated emergency care at hospitals. MHA should prepare impact data on Michigan hospital coverage-loss scenarios and engage both offices as reversal legislation takes shape.

▶ 2:25 **Abdul El-Sayed:** *"So, the first most important thing we can do is the worst of this big ugly bill has not yet happened. They purposely pushed it into January of 2027, and that's the ..."*

▶ 3:03 **Debbie Dingell:** *"one of the first things that we are going to do is to reverse the cuts in Medicaid, reverse the cuts in food to help make sure we don't have hungry children and seniors ..."*

▶ 2:39 **Abdul El-Sayed:** *"And even if you're not on Medicaid, this still affects you. And let me explain why. Those people still get sick. They still need healthare. and instead of getting it in ..."*

02 Medicare for All advocacy from incoming Senator

El-Sayed made single-payer health care his signature issue and will enter the Senate as a vocal advocate for restructuring health care financing around a Medicare model. MHA should monitor for federal single-payer legislation or state-level 'Medicare for Michigan' proposals and assess potential effects on hospital revenue and reimbursement structures.

▶ 0:30 **Abdul El-Sayed:** *"Medicare for Michigan. We did it."*

▶ 8:06 **Abdul El-Sayed:** *"And then when it comes to healthcare, look, the answer here is Medicare for all. There's no reason in the richest, most powerful country in the world where we're ..."*

▶ 15:33 **Abdul El-Sayed:** *"America's greatness is the fight to guarantee all of us the health care we need if we get sick."*

03 Insurer market scrutiny and regulatory pressure

El-Sayed called for breaking up dominant insurers, capping rate increases, and banning stock buybacks, citing the attorney general's lawsuit against Blue Cross Blue Shield as evidence of monopoly power. MHA should watch for federal or state legislation targeting insurer consolidation and rate-setting, which could reshape payer dynamics and contract negotiations for hospitals.

▶ 5:18 **Abdul El-Sayed:** *"And these corporations are telling themselves, in particular, DTE and Blue Cross, right? Both of them functional monopolies, right? The attorney general right now is ..."*

▶ 7:40 **Abdul El-Sayed:** *"So, I think that's part of it. I think they should not be able to just raise rates like that. I don't think they should be able to make money handoverfist. I don't think ..."*

▶ 7:56 **Abdul El-Sayed:** *"The other thing we can do is break them up. Some of these big corporations have gotten so big, have so much power that we just be like, "No, I'm so sorry. You can't just ..."*

04 ACA premium tax credit reinstatement timeline

Dingell committed to reinstating the ACA premium tax credit as an interim coverage measure, and El-Sayed warned of a cost spiral without subsidies in place. MHA should track the scope and timing of reinstatement legislation, as premium subsidies directly affect the size and stability of the insured population hospitals serve.

▶ 3:19 **Debbie Dingell:** *"reinstate the affordable care tax credit until we can figure out what we really need to do to fix a broken health care system."*

▶ 2:56 **Abdul El-Sayed:** *"So premiums are going to go up double digits like they're going to this year. And so we're going to end up having a situation where premiums go up, people get priced out ..."*

03

Themes and what was said

Every verified health statement, grouped by topic and ordered by how directly it bears on hospitals. A statement tagged with several topics appears under the first.

Health care costs & affordability

15 statements · Jocelyn Benson, Abdul El-Sayed, Debbie Dingell

El-Sayed called health care the most unaffordable part of Americans' lives and warned of a premium cost spiral, Dingell listed it among top voter anxieties, and Benson pledged to make health care costs affordable alongside housing, child care, and energy.

DD

Debbie Dingell U.S. Rep., MI-6

DIRECT HOSPITAL STAKES PERSONAL STORY

“two women uh had a long talk with me about the letter they received from the federal government on their Medicaid and they didn't know if they were going to have health insurance and they didn't know how to sort through it all and they didn't know if their child got sick they were going to be able to take them to the doctor or afford their medicine.”

▶ 1:33 Debbie Dingell post-election interview, FOX 2 Detroit · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** Medicaid coverage losses translate directly into uncompensated care and revenue risk for Michigan hospitals that serve newly uninsured patients.

AS

Abdul El-Sayed U.S. Senator-elect

DIRECT HOSPITAL STAKES FRAMING

“And even if you're not on Medicaid, this still affects you. And let me explain why. Those people still get sick. They still need healthare. and instead of getting it in a primary care office before it's a lot worse and more expensive, they have to go to an emergency room.”

▶ 2:39 Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4 · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** Increased ED utilization and uncompensated care directly affect hospital operating margins and capacity.

AS

Abdul El-Sayed U.S. Senator-elect

DIRECT HOSPITAL STAKES CRITICISM

“So premiums are going to go up double digits like they're going to this year. And so we're going to end up having a situation where premiums go up, people get priced out of healthcare. Then premiums go up even more, people get more priced out of healthcare. We have to stop that from happening.”

▶ 2:56 Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4 · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** A shrinking insured population would increase bad debt and charity care obligations for Michigan hospitals.

DD **Debbie Dingell** U.S. Rep., MI-6 DIRECT HOSPITAL STAKES COMMITMENT

“reinstate the affordable care tax credit until we can figure out what we really need to do to fix a broken health care system.”

▶ 3:19 Debbie Dingell post-election interview, FOX 2 Detroit · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** Renewing premium subsidies would help maintain marketplace enrollment in Michigan, protecting hospitals from coverage losses and the associated rise in uncompensated care.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect DIRECT HOSPITAL STAKES CRITICISM

“To defend us all from a health care system more interested in monetizing our illness than healing our bodies and minds.”

▶ 7:12 Abdul El-Sayed victory speech, election night, Detroit · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** This rhetoric signals potential scrutiny of hospital and insurer pricing practices and could inform legislative efforts on transparency or rate regulation.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect DIRECT HOSPITAL STAKES COMMITMENT

“And then when it comes to healthcare, look, the answer here is Medicare for all. There's no reason in the richest, most powerful country in the world where we're spending our money to buy bombs and tanks for other countries that we can't guarantee healthcare.”

▶ 8:06 Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4 · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** A Medicare for All system would fundamentally restructure hospital reimbursement, replacing commercial rates with government-set payment levels.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect DIRECT HOSPITAL STAKES FRAMING

“Shouldn't be this hard to see a doctor in the richest, most powerful country in the world.”

▶ 16:18 Abdul El-Sayed victory speech, election night, Detroit · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** Emphasis on access barriers could drive legislative action on provider shortages, network adequacy, or rural health funding relevant to Michigan hospitals.

DD **Debbie Dingell** U.S. Rep., MI-6 HEALTH SYSTEM FRAMING

“And I think they're very worried about the cost of groceries, gasoline, about whether they can pay their rent, our broken health care system, and corruption. But we've got to address all of that.”

▶ 2:08 Debbie Dingell post-election interview, NBC News · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** Framing the health care system as broken signals potential legislative interest in systemic reforms that could affect hospital operations, reimbursement, or regulation in Michigan.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect HEALTH SYSTEM CRITICISM

“And these corporations are telling themselves, in particular, DTE and Blue Cross, right? Both of them functional monopolies, right? The attorney general right now is suing Blue Cross Blue Shield because they are basically 85% of our insurance market. There's no real meaningful competition.”

▶ 5:18 Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4 · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** Antitrust action against the state's dominant insurer could reshape payer-provider negotiations and reimbursement rates for hospitals.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect HEALTH SYSTEM PERSONAL STORY

“A mom of two kids with a genetic lung disease in East Jordan, fighting the system to make sure her kids don't lose the meds that they rely on to stay alive. Her hope that they don't have to struggle with health insurance like she has.”

▶ 5:47 Abdul El-Sayed victory speech, election night, Detroit · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** Stories like these signal the senator-elect may push for prescription drug affordability and coverage protections that affect hospital pharmacy and patient access.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect HEALTH SYSTEM PERSONAL STORY

“I met a small business owner fighting to make sure that another heart attack doesn't take food off the table for his 30 employees or their families. His hope that his workers don't have to worry about how they'll feed their families.”

▶ 6:35 Abdul El-Sayed victory speech, election night, Detroit · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** This framing may support employer coverage mandates or public option proposals that would change how small-employer patients are insured at hospitals.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect HEALTH SYSTEM FRAMING

“And then finally, look, you know, the cause of my life. I'm a doctor who rebuilt health departments. I want everybody in this country to have healthcare. And if you think about the most unaffordable part of your life, it's actually your healthcare. It's just the part you don't see.”

▶ 7:10 Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4 · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** A senator framing health care as the central affordability crisis signals sustained legislative pressure on costs that could affect hospital pricing and payment models.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect HEALTH SYSTEM CRITICISM

“When you get paid every two weeks or four weeks from from the channel, right, the first group that eats is who? Blue Cross Blue Shield probably, right? It goes right off the top. That's crazy. And they raised their rates. They just got an approval to raise their rates by double digits again from last year. We got to address it.”

▶ 7:21 Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4 · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** Political pressure on insurer rate increases could lead to tighter rate review processes that affect how much insurers reimburse hospitals.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect HEALTH SYSTEM POLICY

“So, I think that's part of it. I think they should not be able to just raise rates like that. I don't think they should be able to make money handoverfist. I don't think corporations should be able to to to engage in stock buybacks, right?”

▶ 7:40 Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4 · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** Restrictions on insurer profits and stock buybacks could redirect capital within the health care system but may also constrain insurer network spending.

JB **Jocelyn Benson** Governor-elect HEALTH SYSTEM COMMITMENT

“We will transform state government to make it efficient and effective and ensure from health care to housing to child care to our energy costs that those costs are affordable for everyone.”

▶ 8:00 Jocelyn Benson and Winnie Brinks transition press conference, Detroit · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** A broad affordability agenda that names health care could lead to state-level actions on insurance premiums, hospital pricing, or coverage costs, but no specifics were offered at this stage.

Insurers, corporate & private-equity influence

7 statements · Abdul El-Sayed

El-Sayed repeatedly targeted insurer market concentration, citing the attorney general's lawsuit against Blue Cross Blue Shield, calling for limits on rate increases and stock buybacks, and advocating breaking up dominant corporations to restore competition.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect HEALTH SYSTEM POLICY

“The other thing we can do is break them up. Some of these big corporations have gotten so big, have so much power that we just be like, "No, I'm so sorry. You can't just keep buying up your competition." There needs to be real competition in the marketplace.”

▶ 7:56 Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4 · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** Breaking up large insurers could create a more fragmented payer landscape, potentially altering hospital contract negotiations.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect

RHETORICAL CRITICISM

“Why? Well, private equity companies have bought up all the leagues and they just raised prices on us. It's an example of the way that corporate malfcence and moneymaking has gotten in the way of so much.”

▶ 6:15 Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4 · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** Though not directly about hospitals, his framing of private equity as predatory could extend to scrutiny of PE-backed health care entities in Michigan.

ACA subsidies & coverage

6 statements · Abdul El-Sayed, Debbie Dingell

Dingell committed to reinstating the ACA premium tax credit as an interim coverage measure while pursuing broader reform, and El-Sayed warned that rising premiums would push more people out of coverage in an accelerating spiral.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect

DIRECT HOSPITAL STAKES FRAMING

“America's greatness is the fight to guarantee all of us the health care we need if we get sick.”

▶ 15:33 Abdul El-Sayed victory speech, election night, Detroit · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** A senator committed to guaranteed coverage could advance legislation expanding insurance enrollment, directly affecting hospital uncompensated care levels.

DD **Debbie Dingell** U.S. Rep., MI-6

RHETORICAL FRAMING

“Fighting for health care for every American when they're sick”

▶ 0:45 Debbie Dingell remarks at Democratic watch party, Hudson's Detroit · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** The remark signals continued rhetorical support for broad coverage but contains no specific policy detail that would directly affect Michigan hospital operations or finances.

Medicaid & Healthy Michigan Plan

5 statements · Abdul El-Sayed, Debbie Dingell

El-Sayed named blocking scheduled Medicaid cuts as a leading Senate priority, Dingell relayed constituent fears about losing coverage after receiving federal letters, and both framed Medicaid protection as among the new majority's most urgent tasks.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect DIRECT HOSPITAL STAKES COMMITMENT

“So, the first most important thing we can do is the worst of this big ugly bill has not yet happened. They purposely pushed it into January of 2027, and that's the Medicaid cuts. We're going to watch tens of thousands of people, right, in in our communities get kicked off their Medicaid roles.”

▶ 2:25 Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4 · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** Large-scale Medicaid disenrollment would increase uncompensated care at Michigan hospitals and reduce a major revenue stream.

DD **Debbie Dingell** U.S. Rep., MI-6 DIRECT HOSPITAL STAKES COMMITMENT

“one of the first things that we are going to do is to reverse the cuts in Medicaid, reverse the cuts in food to help make sure we don't have hungry children and seniors and to address the health care issue”

▶ 3:03 Debbie Dingell post-election interview, FOX 2 Detroit · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** Restoring Medicaid funding would stabilize a major payer source for Michigan hospitals and reduce the risk of rising uninsured patient volumes.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect HEALTH SYSTEM POLICY

“So, I actually think that we're going to be able to get some crossover from Republicans, especially in rural communities, okay, who say, you know what, like this is a crazy thing and we need to address it.”

▶ 3:09 Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4 · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** Bipartisan legislation to preserve Medicaid would be significant for rural Michigan hospitals that depend heavily on Medicaid revenue.

Medicare for All / universal coverage

4 statements · Abdul El-Sayed

El-Sayed championed 'Medicare for Michigan' and Medicare for All as his signature position, opening his victory speech with the phrase and endorsing single-payer as the answer to the affordability crisis throughout his appearances.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect DIRECT HOSPITAL STAKES COMMITMENT

“Medicare for Michigan. We did it.”

▶ 0:30 Abdul El-Sayed victory speech, election night, Detroit · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** A Medicare for Michigan push could restructure hospital reimbursement models and shift payer mix away from private insurance.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect DIRECT HOSPITAL STAKES FRAMING

“this movement for money out of politics, money in your pocket, and Medicare for all.”

▶ 1:47 Abdul El-Sayed victory speech, election night, Detroit · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** A federal Medicare for All effort would fundamentally change hospital revenue streams and eliminate private-payer negotiations.

Public health, vaccines & science

4 statements · Abdul El-Sayed

El-Sayed pledged to fight environmental health hazards including air and water pollution and cited his personal vaccination history as evidence of America's public health infrastructure.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect HEALTH SYSTEM COMMITMENT

“To defend us all from air too putrid to breathe and water too putrid to drink.”

▶ 7:20 Abdul El-Sayed victory speech, election night, Detroit · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** Environmental health advocacy could affect hospital patient volumes related to pollution-linked illnesses and drive community health investment requirements.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect HEALTH SYSTEM PERSONAL STORY

“America vaccinated me against diseases that killed an aunt and uncle I never got to meet.”

▶ 13:54 Abdul El-Sayed victory speech, election night, Detroit · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** Strong pro-vaccine positioning from a physician-senator may support public health funding that sustains hospital immunization programs.

AS **Abdul El-Sayed** U.S. Senator-elect HEALTH SYSTEM FRAMING

“Our greatness is the fight for clean air, clean water, and a good home. Our greatness is the fight for equal pay, for equal work, and full freedom of our bodies.”

▶ 15:39 Abdul El-Sayed victory speech, election night, Detroit · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** The 'full freedom of our bodies' framing suggests support for reproductive health protections that affect OB-GYN services at Michigan hospitals.

Reproductive health & abortion

2 statements · Jocelyn Benson, Abdul El-Sayed

Benson pledged that she and Lieutenant Governor-elect Brinks would protect women's and girls' access to health care and associated rights, and El-Sayed included bodily autonomy language alongside environmental health priorities.

JB **Jocelyn Benson** Governor-elect

HEALTH SYSTEM COMMITMENT

“As governor and lieutenant governor, who will work together every day to ensure that young girls and women always have access to the health care they need and the rights and freedoms they deserve.”

▶ 6:21 Jocelyn Benson victory speech, Hudson's Detroit · Nov 4

> **For hospitals:** The commitment signals continued state-level protection of reproductive health services, which affects hospitals and health systems that provide those services.

Reported in print

leaders with no video found · not in the counts above

Health remarks by leaders whose speeches were not posted on video, as quoted by news outlets and checked against the article. Follow the outlet link for the source.

RP **Ranjeev Puri** House Democratic Leader, likely Speaker

ELECTION NIGHT · PRINT HEALTH SYSTEM

“I watched healthcare be ripped away from our sick. I watched food and benefits taken away from our needy, and I watched tax cuts to billionaire corporations.”

¶ Michigan Advance Election-night speech, Democratic watch party at Hudson's Detroit, Nov. 3

The Detroit News renders it: "I've watched health care be ripped away from our sick."

04

Leader profiles

Each leader's stated agenda in these appearances (any policy area) next to what they said about health. Timestamps open the video at that moment.

Jocelyn Benson

JB

Governor-elect · Secretary of State; elected governor over John James. Takes office Jan. 1, 2027.

2 HEALTH STATEMENTS

Benson framed health care as one element of a broader affordability agenda and pledged to protect women's health access, but did not detail specific health policy proposals in her victory speech or transition press conference.

STATED PRIORITIES

Lower everyday costs	▶ 4:30
Lower costs for families	▶ 4:54
End corruption	▶ 4:58
Grow Michigan's economy	▶ 4:58
Women's health care access	▶ 6:21
Pass state voting rights act	▶ 6:43
Affordable health care and housing	▶ 8:00
Stand up to federal overreach	▶ 10:12

ON HEALTH CARE

Benson pledged that she and Brinks would protect women's and girls' access to health care and associated rights.	▶ 6:21
Benson listed health care among several household cost categories her administration will target for affordability.	▶ 8:00

Jocelyn Benson and Winnie Brinks transition press conference, Detroit (20:18) ↗

Jocelyn Benson victory speech, Hudson's Detroit (12:51) ↗

Abdul El-Sayed

AS

U.S. Senator-elect · Physician and former Detroit health director; won the open U.S. Senate seat over Mike Rogers.

21 HEALTH STATEMENTS

El-Sayed made health care the centerpiece of his victory messaging, advancing Medicare for All, warning of Medicaid cuts and insurer market dominance, and signaling sustained pressure on coverage, costs, and corporate practices in the Senate.

STATED PRIORITIES

Medicare for Michigan / single-payer	▶ 0:30
Get money out of politics	▶ 1:47
Block Medicaid cuts	▶ 2:25

ON HEALTH CARE

El-Sayed opened his victory speech with the campaign's signature call for a Medicare-based universal coverage system in Michigan.	▶ 0:30

Break up monopolies and oligopolies	▶ 3:32
Pass the PRO Act for unions	▶ 3:43
Workers' right to unionize	▶ 6:23
Achieve Medicare for All	▶ 8:06
Fund public education equitably	▶ 10:27

● El-Sayed described his campaign as a three-part movement, with Medicare for All as one of the central planks.	▶ 1:47
● El-Sayed named blocking scheduled Medicaid cuts in the reconciliation bill as his top priority upon entering the Senate.	▶ 2:25
● El-Sayed argued that Medicaid coverage losses shift costs onto the privately insured through higher emergency-room use.	▶ 2:39
● El-Sayed warned of a cost spiral in which rising premiums push more people out of coverage entirely.	▶ 2:56
El-Sayed said he expects bipartisan support to reverse Medicaid cuts, especially from rural-state Republicans.	▶ 3:09
El-Sayed cited the attorney general's lawsuit against Blue Cross Blue Shield's market dominance as evidence of monopoly power in Michigan's insurance market.	▶ 5:18
El-Sayed shared the story of a mother whose children depend on medications for a genetic lung disease and who struggles with health insurance.	▶ 5:47
El-Sayed used private equity's role in youth sports as an analogy for corporate consolidation driving up costs across sectors.	▶ 6:15
El-Sayed described a small business owner whose health crisis threatened the livelihoods of his employees.	▶ 6:35
El-Sayed described universal health care as his life's cause and called health care the most unaffordable part of Americans' lives.	▶ 7:10
● El-Sayed criticized the U.S. health care system as prioritizing profit over patient care, referencing both physical and mental health.	▶ 7:12
El-Sayed pledged to fight environmental health hazards including air and water pollution.	▶ 7:20
El-Sayed criticized Blue Cross Blue Shield for consecutive double-digit rate increases approved by regulators.	▶ 7:21
El-Sayed said he supports legislative limits on insurer rate increases and corporate stock buybacks.	▶ 7:40

El-Sayed advocated breaking up dominant corporations, including large insurers, to restore marketplace competition. ▶ 7:56

- El-Sayed endorsed Medicare for All as the solution to the health care affordability crisis. ▶ 8:06

El-Sayed cited his personal experience with vaccination as evidence of America's public health infrastructure. ▶ 13:54

- El-Sayed framed universal health care access as a core American value. ▶ 15:33

El-Sayed included bodily autonomy language alongside environmental health priorities. ▶ 15:39

- El-Sayed decried the difficulty of accessing medical care despite national wealth. ▶ 16:18

Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4 (12:16) ↗

Abdul El-Sayed victory speech, election night, Detroit (21:44) ↗

WB Winnie Brinks

Lieutenant Governor-elect · Senate Majority Leader; Benson's running mate.

0 HEALTH STATEMENTS

Brinks did not address health care in her analyzed appearances, focusing her remarks on affordability broadly and collaborative governance.

STATED PRIORITIES

Bipartisan collaboration ▶ 2:30

Lower costs and affordability ▶ 5:30

ON HEALTH CARE

Did not address health care in the appearances reviewed.

Jocelyn Benson and Winnie Brinks transition press conference, Detroit (20:18) ↗

Jocelyn Benson victory speech, Hudson's Detroit (12:51) ↗

CJ Curtis Hertel Jr.

Michigan Democratic Party Chair · MDP chair; spoke at the Hudson's Detroit watch party.

0 HEALTH STATEMENTS

Hertel did not address health care, directing his remarks toward the party's electoral victories across the full ticket.

STATED PRIORITIES

Defeat Republican statewide candidates ▶ 0:26

ON HEALTH CARE

Did not address health care in the appearances reviewed.

Win across the full ticket ▶ 0:50

Curtis Hertel remarks at Democratic watch party, Hudson's Detroit (1:06) ↗

MM Mallory McMorrow

State Senator · Senate Majority Whip.

0 HEALTH STATEMENTS

McMorrow did not address health care, focusing her remarks on economic concerns, grassroots organizing, and support for the Senate candidate.

STATED PRIORITIES

- Support U.S. Senate candidate ▶ 0:28
- Address economic concerns ▶ 0:49
- Elect Democrats to trifecta ▶ 1:13
- Build grassroots energy statewide ▶ 1:20

ON HEALTH CARE

Did not address health care in the appearances reviewed.

Mallory McMorrow interview with WWMT, election night (1:58) ↗

DD Debbie Dingell

U.S. Rep., MI-6 · Re-elected.

5 HEALTH STATEMENTS

Dingell centered Medicaid protection and affordability as immediate concerns, committing to reverse federal Medicaid cuts as among 'one of the first things' the new House majority would pursue and to reinstate the ACA premium tax credit.

STATED PRIORITIES

- Civil rights and equality ▶ 0:37
- Health care access ▶ 0:45
- Reducing food costs ▶ 0:50
- Standing against hate ▶ 1:13
- Lower grocery and housing costs ▶ 1:17
- Deliver results quickly ▶ 1:50
- Lower grocery and gas costs ▶ 2:08
- Fix the health care system ▶ 2:08

ON HEALTH CARE

- Dingell listed health care access among core Democratic values that volunteers have championed. ▶ 0:45
- Dingell described a Sunday encounter at a Kroger where two women told her they feared losing Medicaid coverage and access to care for their children after receiving federal letters. ▶ 1:33
- Dingell characterized the health care system as 'broken' and listed it among top voter anxieties that the new Democratic majority must address. ▶ 2:08

- Dingell said the Democratic House majority's first-100-hours agenda will reverse federal Medicaid cuts and food assistance reductions. ▶ 3:03
- Dingell committed to reinstating the ACA premium tax credit as an interim measure while pursuing broader health system reform. ▶ 3:19

Debbie Dingell post-election interview, FOX 2 Detroit (3:39) ↗ Debbie Dingell post-election interview, NBC News (3:16) ↗
Debbie Dingell remarks at Democratic watch party, Hudson's Detroit (1:33) ↗

RP

Ranjeev Puri

House Democratic Leader, likely Speaker · House Minority Leader 2025-26; Democrats flipped the state House.

PRINT COVERAGE ONLY
NO VIDEO FOUND

Puri was not captured on video, but per the Michigan Advance he decried health care being 'ripped away' at the election-night watch party. He named no specific health policy that night.

ELECTION NIGHT · PRINT HEALTH SYSTEM

"I watched healthcare be ripped away from our sick. I watched food and benefits taken away from our needy, and I watched tax cuts to billionaire corporations."

¶ Michigan Advance Election-night speech, Democratic watch party at Hudson's Detroit, Nov. 3

The Detroit News renders it: "I've watched health care be ripped away from our sick."

ELECTION NIGHT · PRINT

"The people of Michigan spoke up tonight and said that they've had enough, and they delivered a House Democratic majority."

¶ Michigan Advance Election-night speech, Democratic watch party at Hudson's Detroit, Nov. 3

DC

Darrin Camilleri

State Senator · Assistant Senate Majority Leader 2025-26; possible Senate leadership candidate.

PRINT COVERAGE ONLY
NO VIDEO FOUND

Camilleri was not captured on video, and his post-election statement, per The Detroit News, focused on the Senate Democratic majority's electoral success without addressing health care.

ELECTION NIGHT · PRINT

“Every one of our candidates left it all on the field and because of their hard work, Michiganders will have an expanded majority in the state Senate that's ready to deliver even more progress for the people of our state.”

¶ The Detroit News — Post-election statement as chair of the Senate Democratic Fund (setting not reported)

● marks statements with direct hospital stakes. Dashed cards are leaders known only from news quotes.

A

Source videos

One recording per event was transcribed (the most complete available). Other uploads of the same event are counted under Alt.

DATE	EVENT	SPEAKERS	LENGTH	RECORDING	HEALTH	ALT
Nov 3	**Curtis Hertel remarks at Democratic watch party, Hudson's Detroit** Remarks	Curtis Hertel Jr.	1:06	WWMT-TV ↗ Captions · clip	0	
Nov 3	**Mallory McMorrow interview with WWMT, election night** Interview	Mallory McMorrow	1:58	WWMT-TV ↗ Captions	0	
Nov 4	**Abdul El-Sayed post-election interview, WDIV Local 4** Interview	Abdul El-Sayed	12:16	Click On Detroit ↗ Captions	11	
Nov 4	**Abdul El-Sayed victory speech, election night, Detroit** Victory speech	Abdul El-Sayed	21:44	C-SPAN ↗ Captions	10	24
Nov 4	**Debbie Dingell post-election interview, FOX 2 Detroit** Interview	Debbie Dingell	3:39	FOX 2 Detroit ↗ Captions	3	
Nov 4	**Debbie Dingell post-election interview, NBC News** Interview	Debbie Dingell	3:16	NBC News ↗ Captions	1	
Nov 4	**Debbie Dingell remarks at Democratic watch party, Hudson's Detroit** Remarks	Debbie Dingell	1:33	CBS Detroit ↗ Captions · clip	1	
Nov 4	**Jocelyn Benson and Winnie Brinks transition press conference, Detroit** Press conference	Jocelyn Benson, Winnie Brinks	20:18	CBS Detroit ↗ Whisper transcript	1	
Nov 4	**Jocelyn Benson victory speech, Hudson's Detroit** Victory speech	Jocelyn Benson, Winnie Brinks	12:51	Click On Detroit ↗ Captions	1	20

SEARCHED FOR, NOT FOUND

No qualifying post-election video was found for: Eli Savit (Attorney General-elect); Michigan Senate Democrats (Senate majority caucus); Sean McCann (U.S. Rep.-elect, MI-4); William Lawrence (U.S. Rep.-elect, MI-7); Christina Hines (U.S. Rep.-elect, MI-10); Jeremy Moss (U.S. Rep.-elect, MI-11); Hillary Scholten (U.S. Rep., MI-3); Kristen McDonald Rivet (U.S. Rep., MI-8); Donavan McKinney (U.S. Rep.-elect, MI-13); Rashida Tlaib (U.S. Rep., MI-12); Gretchen Whitmer (Governor (outgoing)). Their remarks may exist only as print quotes or in live broadcasts not posted separately. Print quotes for several of them are collected in the Election-Fallout research notes (github.com/AndySwirczek/Election-Fallout). Rerunning the pipeline picks up any videos posted later. Ranjeev Puri and Darrin Camilleri also had no video; their news-reported quotes appear in the leader profiles.

Methodology

Videos were found by searching YouTube for each tracked leader (newest-first and by relevance) and by checking video links collected in the Election-Fallout research notes, keeping uploads from November 3, 2026 onward. Claude screened every result, kept only videos where a tracked leader speaks at length after the polls closed, and grouped re-uploads of the same speech so each event is analyzed once, from the most complete recording (other uploads are listed in the appendix). Transcripts come from YouTube captions where available and Whisper speech-to-text otherwise. Claude then listed every statement about health or health care by a tracked leader and each leader's stated priorities. Every quote was matched back to the transcript text; quotes that could not be located were dropped. For leaders with no video, quotes reported by news outlets are shown separately, marked with the outlet and linked to the article; they were checked against the article text, are not counted in the totals, and pre-election remarks are labeled as such. Broadcast captions typed in all capitals are shown in sentence case; no words were changed. Timestamps link to the moment in the video on YouTube; for recordings hosted elsewhere, the timestamp is printed beside the link.

Note

Prepared with AI assistance (Claude) for internal MHA use. Quotes are drawn from automated transcripts and machine-verified against the transcript text, but transcription errors are possible. Check the linked video before citing a quote externally.

DIRECT HOSPITAL STAKES HEALTH SYSTEM RHETORICAL relevance of each statement to hospitals, as classified by the analysis